

EVERYDAY MILLIONAIRE

Tori grew up in a lower-middle-class family and was responsible for her own finances at a young age. She never got an allowance and always had to work for every dollar she had. Well, almost every dollar. She remembers her aunt giving her a birthday card for her seventh birthday. When she opened the card, Tori found ten dimes taped to the inside. It was such a special, significant gift that Tori never spent the money. In fact, she still has that card—dimes included—as one of her most prized possessions.

All through high school, Tori had a specific career goal: she wanted to be a CPA. Back then, she says, women weren't generally working as CPAs. She didn't let that stop her, though. She completed her degree and started working in accounting right out of college. Her family's financial background and her accounting education shaped her approach to money. Because of the money stress she constantly saw in her parents, Tori committed early on that she would become financially independent. From the day she became responsible for her own finances at age fifteen, she set a goal of having enough money to live comfortably—more comfortably than her parents could have imagined. Throughout her entire career, Tori kept that goal in mind, and it guided all her financial decisions. She never bought anything she couldn't pay cash for. She worked and saved to put herself through school and to purchase her own home. When her friends bought brand-new cars, she bought five-year-old cars. She never got distracted, and she never stopped saving. Today, she and her husband are retired multimillionaires with a net worth of \$2.7 million and are living the life they've dreamed of—and worked for—for decades.

Tori knows she's lived a much different life than most people. As an accountant, she's seen people waste an unbelievable amount of money. She's seen every mistake imaginable, watching families lose millions in potential wealth by running after new cars, giant houses, and ridiculous vacations. When we asked Tori what her secret was, though, she said everything she's accomplished is the result of starting early, sticking with it, and the power of compound interest. She knows, even now in retirement, that the decisions she made in her twenties led her directly to where she is today. Her advice to the next generation? It's simple, she says. "Be disciplined early on and stick to it for at least ten years." She's learned through decades of patience and hard work that consistency pays off . . . *big time*.

Be disciplined early on and stick to it. Such a simple formula, but it captures everything I've been talking about. Slow and steady, low and slow, you will build wealth if you do what these millionaires have done: consistently invest in your 401(k) or other retirement accounts, consistently